

# **AI Literacy for ESL Students**

A Practical Guide for Adult Migrant English Learners

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## **AI Literacy for ESL Students**

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First edition, 2026

Published via Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing

Cover design by Mircea's Constellation AI

ISBN: [assigned by KDP]

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# Chapter 1: What is AI?

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Understand what Artificial Intelligence (AI) means in simple words
  - Know examples of AI you already use every day
  - Feel confident talking about AI with others
- 

## What is AI?

AI stands for **Artificial Intelligence**.

Let's break those two words down:

- **Artificial** = made by people (not natural)
- **Intelligence** = the ability to think, learn, and solve problems

So AI is a **computer program that can think and learn**.

But AI does not think like a person. It does not have feelings. It does not get tired. It looks at millions of examples and finds patterns. Then it uses those patterns to help you.

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# AI You Already Use

You probably use AI every day without knowing it. Here are some examples:

| What you do                      | The AI behind it     |
|----------------------------------|----------------------|
| Ask Siri or Google a question    | Voice recognition AI |
| Use Google Translate             | Language AI          |
| Get Netflix recommendations      | Recommendation AI    |
| Unlock your phone with your face | Face recognition AI  |
| Use autocorrect when typing      | Text prediction AI   |
| Get directions on Google Maps    | Route planning AI    |

**You are already an AI user.**

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## How Does AI Learn?

Imagine you want to teach a child what a cat is.

You show them 100 pictures of cats. After seeing enough pictures, the child can recognise a new cat they have never seen before.

AI works the same way — but with millions of examples, not 100.

This is called **machine learning**. The computer learns from examples.

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## AI is a Tool

Think of AI like a calculator.

A calculator does not replace a person. But it helps a person work faster and make fewer mistakes.

AI is the same. It is a **tool** that helps you:

- Write better English
- Understand documents
- Find information
- Practice speaking
- Fill out forms

**AI does not replace you. It helps you.**

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## Key Words

| Word             | Meaning                                             |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| AI               | Artificial Intelligence — a computer that can learn |
| Machine learning | When a computer learns from examples                |
| Tool             | Something that helps you do a job                   |
| Artificial       | Made by people, not natural                         |
| Pattern          | Something that repeats in a regular way             |

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## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Find the AI (Cert I)

Look at your phone. Find three apps that use AI. Write their names:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 2: AI or Not AI? (Cert II)

Read each sentence. Write YES if it is AI, or NO if it is not AI.

1. Google Translate translates a sentence for you. \_\_\_\_

2. You turn on a light switch. \_\_\_\_

3. Netflix suggests a movie you might like. \_\_\_\_

4. You use a paper dictionary. \_\_\_\_

5. Your phone corrects your spelling. \_\_\_\_

### Activity 3: Explain AI (Cert III)

In your own words, explain what AI is to a classmate. Use at least three sentences. You can start with:

*"AI stands for... It works by... An example is..."*

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## Teacher's Note

This chapter introduces AI without jargon. The key message is that students are already AI users — this removes fear and builds confidence. Use the phone activity as a warm-up to show that AI is not new or scary to them.

Estimated class time: 45-60 minutes

Materials needed: students' phones, whiteboard

# Chapter 2: AI Tools You Can Use Today

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Know five free AI tools that help with English
  - Be able to open and use each tool
  - Understand what each tool is best for
- 

## Five Free AI Tools

These tools are **free** and work on your phone or computer.

### 1. ChatGPT (by OpenAI)

**What it does:** You type a question in any language. It answers in English (or any language you choose).

**Best for:** Practising English, asking questions, getting explanations

**How to use it:**

1. Go to [chatgpt.com](https://chatgpt.com) on your phone or computer
2. Create a free account (email + password)
3. Type your question in the box



4. Press Enter

**Try this now:**

Type: *"Explain what Medicare is in Australia. Use simple English."*

---

## 2. Google Translate

**What it does:** Translates words, sentences, or whole pages between languages.

**Best for:** Understanding documents, signs, letters from school

**How to use it:**

1. Open the Google Translate app (free on iPhone and Android)
2. Choose your language on the left
3. Choose English on the right
4. Type, speak, or take a photo

**Special feature:** Point your phone camera at a sign or letter. Google Translate shows the English on your screen instantly.

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## 3. Grammarly

**What it does:** Checks your English writing for mistakes and suggests corrections.

**Best for:** Emails, job applications, assignments

**How to use it:**

1. Go to [grammarly.com](https://grammarly.com)
2. Create a free account

3. Paste your writing

4. Grammarly highlights mistakes in red and suggests fixes

**Try this now:**

Type this sentence with mistakes: *"I am go to the shops yesterday."*

Watch Grammarly fix it to: *"I went to the shops yesterday."*

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## 4. Elsa Speak

**What it does:** Listens to you speak English and tells you how to improve your pronunciation.

**Best for:** Speaking practice, pronunciation, confidence

**How to use it:**

1. Download ELSA Speak from the App Store or Google Play (free version available)
  2. Choose your first language
  3. Follow the speaking exercises
  4. The app shows you which sounds to improve
- 

## 5. Microsoft Copilot

**What it does:** Like ChatGPT, but built into Microsoft products. Helps with writing, summarising, and answering questions.

**Best for:** Writing emails, understanding long documents, homework help

**How to use it:**

1. Go to [copilot.microsoft.com](https://copilot.microsoft.com)

- 2. Sign in with a Microsoft account (free)
- 3. Type your question

## Which Tool Should I Use?

| I want to...                    | Use this tool               |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Ask a question in my language   | ChatGPT or Google Translate |
| Check my English writing        | Grammarly                   |
| Practise speaking English       | ELSA Speak                  |
| Understand a letter or document | Google Translate (camera)   |
| Write an email                  | Grammarly + ChatGPT         |
| Prepare for a job interview     | ChatGPT                     |

## Key Words

| Word          | Meaning                                |
|---------------|----------------------------------------|
| App           | A program on your phone                |
| Account       | Your personal login (email + password) |
| Free version  | You can use it without paying          |
| Pronunciation | How you say a word                     |
| Translate     | Change from one language to another    |

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## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Set Up One Tool (Cert I)

Choose ONE tool from this chapter. Set it up on your phone. Show your teacher that it works.

Tool I chose: \_\_\_\_\_

It works: YES / NO

### Activity 2: Compare Two Tools (Cert II)

Use ChatGPT AND Google Translate to translate the same sentence from your language to English. Write both translations below. Are they the same or different?

My sentence: \_\_\_\_\_

ChatGPT translation: \_\_\_\_\_

Google Translate translation: \_\_\_\_\_

Same or different? \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 3: Write a Review (Cert III)

Choose one AI tool from this chapter. Use it for one week. Then write a short review (5-8 sentences):

- What is the tool?
- What did you use it for?
- What was good about it?
- What was not good?
- Would you recommend it? Why?

---

## Teacher's Note

This is a hands-on chapter. Students should have phones ready. Walk around the room and help with account creation — many students struggle with email/password steps. Pair stronger students with beginners.

The ChatGPT exercise works best if students ask questions about their real life (Medicare, Centrelink, school enrolment).

Estimated class time: 90 minutes (allow time for setup)

Materials needed: students' phones, Wi-Fi access

# Chapter 3: Staying Safe Online with AI

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Know the three main risks of using AI
  - Understand how to protect your personal information
  - Recognise AI scams and fake content
- 

## Three Rules for AI Safety

### Rule 1: Never Share Personal Details with AI

AI chatbots like ChatGPT are helpful, but they are **not private**. Do not type:

- Your full name + date of birth together
- Your Tax File Number (TFN)
- Your Medicare number
- Your bank account or card numbers
- Your passwords
- Your home address

**It is OK to ask:** *"How do I apply for Medicare?"*

**It is NOT OK to type:** *"My Medicare number is 1234 5678 9, can you check my claim?"*

Think of AI like a stranger in a shop. You can ask for directions, but you would not give them your wallet.

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## Rule 2: AI Can Be Wrong

AI is very confident, but it is **not always correct**.

AI can:

- Give you the wrong date or fact
- Make up information that sounds real (this is called a "hallucination")
- Give outdated information

**Always check important information** with an official source:

- Government websites (.gov.au)
- Your teacher
- Your doctor
- Your bank

### Example:

You ask ChatGPT: *"What are the Centrelink payment dates for 2025?"*

ChatGPT might give you wrong dates. Always check on [servicesaustralia.gov.au](https://servicesaustralia.gov.au).

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## Rule 3: Watch Out for AI Scams

Scammers now use AI to:

- **Write fake emails** that look real (phishing)
- **Clone voices** to pretend to be your family
- **Create fake photos** of people who don't exist
- **Make fake videos** (deepfakes)

#### **How to protect yourself:**

- If an email asks you to click a link urgently — stop and check
  - If someone calls asking for money — hang up and call them back on the real number
  - If a deal looks too good to be true — it probably is
  - If you're not sure — ask your teacher, a friend, or call the Scamwatch hotline: **1300 795 995**
- 

## **What AI Companies Do With Your Data**

When you use a free AI tool, the company may:

- Read what you type to improve their AI
- Store your conversations
- Use your data for training

This is why Rule 1 matters. If you type personal information, it could be stored.

**Tip:** Most AI tools have a "don't train on my data" setting. Ask your teacher to help you turn it on.

---

## **Key Words**



| Word                 | Meaning                                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Personal information | Details about you (name, address, numbers)    |
| Scam                 | A trick to steal your money or information    |
| Phishing             | A fake email or message pretending to be real |
| Hallucination        | When AI makes up wrong information            |
| Deepfake             | A fake video or photo made by AI              |
| Privacy              | Keeping your information safe and private     |

# Practice Activities

## Activity 1: Safe or Unsafe? (Cert I)

Read each sentence. Write SAFE or UNSAFE.

- 1. You ask ChatGPT: "What is a resume?" \_\_\_\_
- 2. You type your bank password into ChatGPT. \_\_\_\_
- 3. You use Google Translate to read a letter from school. \_\_\_\_
- 4. You give your TFN to an AI chatbot. \_\_\_\_
- 5. You ask ChatGPT to help you write a job application. \_\_\_\_

## Activity 2: Spot the Scam (Cert II)

Read this email. Is it real or a scam? Write three reasons for your answer.

*"Dear Customer, Your Centrelink payment has been stopped. Click this link NOW to verify your identity or you will lose your payment: [www.centrelink-verify-urgent.com](http://www.centrelink-verify-urgent.com)"*

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

### **Activity 3: Create a Safety Poster (Cert III)**

Make a poster for your classroom with the three AI safety rules. Include:

- The three rules in simple English
  - One example for each rule
  - A phone number to call if you think you have been scammed
- 

### **Teacher's Note**

This chapter is critical for student safety. Many AMEP students are targeted by scams because of language barriers. The phishing example uses a realistic Centrelink scam — adapt it to your students' context. Consider inviting a guest speaker from Services Australia or local police.

Estimated class time: 60-75 minutes

Materials needed: whiteboard, printed example emails (optional)

# Chapter 4: Using AI to Practice Speaking

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to practise speaking English at home
  - Know how to have a conversation with ChatGPT using voice
  - Improve your pronunciation with ELSA Speak
- 

## Why Practice Speaking with AI?

Many ESL students say: *"I understand English, but I am scared to speak."*

AI can help because:

- **AI does not judge you** — it will never laugh at your mistakes
  - **AI is always available** — practise at midnight if you want
  - **AI is patient** — it will repeat the same thing 100 times
  - **AI is free** — no cost for speaking practice
- 

## Method 1: Voice Chat with ChatGPT

The ChatGPT app (iPhone and Android) has a **voice mode**.

**How to use it:**

1. Open the ChatGPT app
2. Tap the headphone icon at the bottom
3. Speak in English (or your language)
4. ChatGPT will listen and respond with voice

**Great prompts to try:**

*"I am an ESL student at Cert II level. Please have a simple conversation with me about my weekend. Correct my mistakes gently."*

*"I have a job interview tomorrow for a cleaning job. Please practise interview questions with me. Speak slowly."*

*"Let's practise ordering food at a restaurant. You are the waiter. I am the customer."*

**Tip:** Tell ChatGPT your level. Say *"I am a beginner"* or *"I am intermediate."* It will adjust.

---

## **Method 2: ELSA Speak for Pronunciation**

ELSA Speak listens to your pronunciation and scores you.

**How it works:**

1. ELSA shows you a sentence
2. You read it out loud
3. ELSA highlights which sounds were good (green) and which need work (red)

4. You try again

**Focus areas for ESL students:**

- The "th" sound (this, that, think)
- The "v" vs "w" sound (very vs. wery)
- Word stress (DEsert vs. deSERT)
- The "r" and "l" sounds

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## Method 3: Record Yourself

This method uses no special app — just your phone's voice recorder.

1. Choose a topic (e.g., "My family")
2. Record yourself speaking for 1 minute
3. Listen to your recording
4. Type what you said into ChatGPT
5. Ask: *"Please correct my English and explain the mistakes"*
6. Record yourself again with the corrections

This is how professional language learners improve. You are training your ear and your mouth at the same time.

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## Daily Speaking Practice Plan

| Day    | Activity                             | Time   |
|--------|--------------------------------------|--------|
| Monday | Voice chat with ChatGPT (free topic) | 10 min |

|           |                                                             |        |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Tuesday   | ELSA Speak pronunciation drills                             | 10 min |
| Wednesday | Record yourself, correct with ChatGPT                       | 15 min |
| Thursday  | Voice chat: practise a real scenario (shop, doctor, bank)   | 10 min |
| Friday    | ELSA Speak + record improvement                             | 15 min |
| Weekend   | Watch an English YouTube video, repeat 3 sentences out loud | 10 min |

**Total: about 10-15 minutes per day. That is all you need.**

---

## Key Words

|               |                                                       |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Word          | Meaning                                               |
| Pronunciation | How you say a word                                    |
| Voice mode    | When AI listens and speaks (not just text)            |
| Prompt        | The instruction or question you give to AI            |
| Scenario      | A situation (like ordering food or visiting a doctor) |
| Correct       | To fix a mistake                                      |

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## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: First Voice Chat (Cert I)

Open ChatGPT voice mode. Say: *"Hello, my name is [your name]. I am learning English."*

Listen to ChatGPT's response. Did you understand it? YES / NO

### Activity 2: Role Play (Cert II)

Use ChatGPT voice mode for this scenario:

- You are at the doctor
- Tell the doctor you have a headache and a sore throat
- Ask for a medical certificate for work

Write down two new words you learned: \_\_\_\_\_,  
\_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 3: Before and After (Cert III)

1. Record yourself talking about your daily routine (1 minute)
2. Get corrections from ChatGPT
3. Record yourself again with the corrections
4. Listen to both recordings

What improved? Write 2-3 sentences:

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

## Teacher's Note

Voice chat with ChatGPT is a game-changer for students who won't speak in class. Assign it as homework — students practise privately at home and build

confidence before speaking in front of classmates.

ELSA Speak's free tier is limited but sufficient for classroom use. The paid version (\$4/month) is worth recommending to motivated students.

Estimated class time: 60 minutes (including setup)

Materials needed: students' phones, earphones recommended



# Chapter 5: Using AI to Practice Writing

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to check and improve your English writing
  - Write emails, messages, and short texts with AI help
  - Understand the difference between AI writing FOR you and AI helping you write
- 

## Important Rule: AI Helps You Write — It Does Not Write For You

If you copy AI's words and say they are yours, that is not learning. Use AI like a teacher who checks your work and explains your mistakes.

**Good way:** You write first. Then AI checks and explains.

**Bad way:** You ask AI to write everything. You copy and paste.

---

## Method 1: Write, Then Check with ChatGPT

1. Write your text in English (even with mistakes — that's OK)
2. Paste it into ChatGPT
3. Type: *"Please correct my English. Explain each mistake so I can learn."*

**Example:**

You write: *"Yesterday I am go to shop and buy milk. The shop was close so I go other shop."*

ChatGPT corrects: *"Yesterday I went to the shop and bought milk. The shop was closed so I went to another shop."*

And explains:

- "am go" → "went" (past tense)
- "buy" → "bought" (past tense of buy)
- "close" → "closed" (adjective)
- "other shop" → "another shop" (use "another" for one different thing)

**This is better than a dictionary** because it explains YOUR specific mistakes.

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## **Method 2: Grammarly for Everyday Writing**

Install Grammarly on your phone or computer. It checks your writing automatically in:

- Gmail
- WhatsApp Web
- Facebook
- Any text box in your browser

Every time you write, Grammarly shows a red underline for mistakes and suggests a fix. Over time, you start making fewer mistakes because you learn the patterns.

---

## Method 3: Email Templates

Ask ChatGPT to help you write common emails:

### **Calling in sick to work:**

*"Help me write a short email to my boss. I am sick today and cannot come to work. Keep it simple and polite."*

### **Asking about a bill:**

*"Help me write an email to my electricity company. I think my bill is wrong. The amount is \$450 but last month it was \$120. I want them to check it."*

### **Replying to your child's school:**

*"The school sent me a note about a parent-teacher meeting on Friday. Help me write a reply saying I will attend."*

Save these emails as templates on your phone. Next time, change the details and send.

---

## Method 4: Daily Writing Journal

Keep a simple English journal. Write 3 sentences every day:

1. What I did today
2. How I feel
3. One new thing I learned

Once a week, paste your journal entries into ChatGPT and ask: *"Please correct my writing from this week and tell me my most common mistakes."*

---

## Common Writing Mistakes for ESL Students

| Mistake                | Wrong                   | Correct                       |
|------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Missing articles       | "I went to shop"        | "I went to <b>the</b> shop"   |
| Wrong tense            | "Yesterday I go"        | "Yesterday I <b>went</b> "    |
| Subject-verb agreement | "She have two children" | "She <b>has</b> two children" |
| Prepositions           | "I arrive to work"      | "I arrive <b>at</b> work"     |
| Plural confusion       | "I have two childs"     | "I have two <b>children</b> " |

Ask ChatGPT: *"What are the most common English mistakes for [your language] speakers?"* — it will give you a personalised list.

---

## Key Words

| Word     | Meaning                                        |
|----------|------------------------------------------------|
| Grammar  | The rules of a language                        |
| Correct  | To fix a mistake                               |
| Template | A ready-made document you can change and reuse |
| Journal  | A diary — a book where you write regularly     |
| Tense    | The time of a verb (past, present, future)     |

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## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Correct My Text (Cert I)

Write 3 sentences about your family. Give them to ChatGPT. Write the corrected version below:

My sentences: \_\_\_\_\_

Corrected: \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 2: Write an Email (Cert II)

Write an email to your child's school saying your child will be absent tomorrow because they are sick. Use ChatGPT to check it. Print the final version.

### Activity 3: One-Week Journal (Cert III)

Write 3 sentences in English every day for one week. At the end of the week, paste all entries into ChatGPT. Write down your three most common mistakes:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

# Chapter 6: Using AI to Build Vocabulary

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to learn new English words faster
  - Create personal vocabulary lists with AI
  - Use flashcard apps powered by AI
- 

## Why Vocabulary Matters

Grammar is the skeleton. Vocabulary is the muscle.

If you know 1,000 English words, you can understand about 80% of everyday conversation. At 3,000 words, you reach 95%. AI can help you get there faster than any textbook.

---

## Method 1: Personal Word Lists from ChatGPT

Type into ChatGPT:

*"I work in a warehouse. Give me 20 important English words I need for my job. Include the word, a simple definition, and an example sentence."*

Or:

*"I am going to the doctor next week. Give me 15 medical words I should know. Keep definitions very simple."*

Or:

*"My child starts school next week. What English words do I need to talk to teachers? Give me 20 words with examples."*

**AI gives you the exact words you need — not random textbook words.**

---

## Method 2: Word of the Day

Every morning, ask ChatGPT:

*"Give me one useful English word for today. Include: the word, pronunciation, meaning, an example sentence, and one synonym."*

Write it on a sticky note. Put it on your fridge. By the end of the month, you know 30 new words.

---

## Method 3: AI Flashcards with Anki

Anki is a free flashcard app that uses AI-style spaced repetition — it shows you words just before you forget them.

### Setup:

1. Download Anki (free on computer, free on Android, paid on iPhone)
2. Ask ChatGPT: *"Create 20 Anki flashcards for ESL beginners about shopping. Format: front | back"*
3. Import the list into Anki

4. Study 5 minutes per day

**Or use Quizlet** (free, works on all phones) — same idea, easier to set up.

---

## Method 4: Learn Words from Context

Instead of memorising word lists, learn words from real situations:

1. Take a photo of something (a letter, a sign, a menu)
2. Upload it to ChatGPT
3. Ask: *"What are the important words in this image? Explain each one simply."*

This works with:

- Letters from Centrelink
  - Medicine labels
  - School newsletters
  - Supermarket signs
  - Bus timetables
- 

## Method 5: Vocabulary by Topic

Here are starter prompts for common life topics:

| Topic    | ChatGPT Prompt                                      |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Shopping | <i>"20 words for grocery shopping in Australia"</i> |
| Health   | <i>"20 words for visiting a doctor"</i>             |



|           |                                                           |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Transport | <i>"15 words for using trains and buses in Melbourne"</i> |
| Banking   | <i>"15 words for opening a bank account"</i>              |
| Housing   | <i>"20 words for renting a house or flat"</i>             |
| Work      | <i>"20 words for a job interview"</i>                     |
| School    | <i>"15 words for talking to my child's teacher"</i>       |

---

# Key Words

| Word              | Meaning                                                  |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Vocabulary        | All the words you know in a language                     |
| Flashcard         | A card with a word on one side and meaning on the other  |
| Synonym           | A word with a similar meaning (e.g., big = large)        |
| Context           | The situation around a word that helps you understand it |
| Spaced repetition | Reviewing words at increasing intervals to remember them |

---

# Practice Activities

## Activity 1: My Top 10 Words (Cert I)

Ask ChatGPT for 10 words about a topic important to you. Write them here:

Topic: \_\_\_\_\_

1. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

4. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

5. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

6. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

7. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

8. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

9. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

10. \_\_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_

## Activity 2: Photo Vocabulary (Cert II)

Take a photo of something in English (a sign, a letter, a label). Upload it to ChatGPT. Write down 5 new words you learned:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

4. \_\_\_\_\_

5. \_\_\_\_\_

## Activity 3: Week Challenge (Cert III)

Learn one new word per day for 7 days using ChatGPT's "word of the day."  
At the end of the week, write all 7 words in a sentence:

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# Chapter 7: AI for Reading Comprehension

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to understand difficult English texts
  - Simplify letters, documents, and articles with AI
  - Build reading skills step by step
- 

## The Problem

You receive a letter from Centrelink. It says:

*"Your Income Support Payment has been reassessed pursuant to Section 1067G of the Social Security Act 1991. The adjusted rate reflects updated circumstances as reported on 14 March 2025."*

You understand some words but not the meaning. This is normal. Even native English speakers find government letters confusing.

---

## Method 1: Simplify with ChatGPT

Copy the text and paste it into ChatGPT. Type:

*"Please explain this in very simple English for someone learning the language:"*

ChatGPT might respond:

*"Centrelink looked at your payment again. Because your situation changed (something you told them on 14 March), your payment amount is now different."*

Now you understand.

**This works for:**

- Government letters (Centrelink, Medicare, ATO)
  - Rental agreements
  - School reports and newsletters
  - Employment contracts
  - Medical results
  - Insurance documents
- 

## **Method 2: Ask Follow-up Questions**

After ChatGPT simplifies the text, you can ask:

- *"What should I do about this letter?"*
- *"Do I need to call someone?"*
- *"Is this good news or bad news for me?"*
- *"What does 'reassessed' mean exactly?"*

AI becomes your personal reading assistant.

---

## Method 3: Read News at Your Level

Ask ChatGPT:

*"Find a news story from Australia today and rewrite it for an ESL beginner. Use short sentences and simple words."*

Or:

*"Explain what is happening in Australian politics right now. Use simple English. I am at intermediate level."*

### Free news websites for ESL students:

- **SBS Easy English** ([sbs.com.au](https://www.sbs.com.au/easyenglish)) — news in simple English
  - **News in Levels** ([newsinlevels.com](https://www.newsinlevels.com)) — same news at 3 difficulty levels
  - **Simple English Wikipedia** — Wikipedia written simply
- 

## Method 4: Reading with Translation Support

1. Open an English article on your phone
2. Read it first — try to understand without help
3. Highlight words you don't know
4. Ask ChatGPT: *"What do these words mean? [paste your list]"*
5. Read the article again with your new vocabulary

This is called **extensive reading** — reading a lot at a comfortable level. It is the fastest way to improve naturally.

---

## Method 5: Understanding Forms

Many students struggle with forms (Centrelink, tax, school enrolment).

Take a photo of the form. Upload to ChatGPT:

*"This is an Australian government form. Please explain what each section asks for in simple English. Tell me what I need to write in each box."*

ChatGPT will walk you through the form field by field.

---

## Key Words

| Word          | Meaning                                                      |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Comprehension | Understanding what you read                                  |
| Simplify      | Make something easier to understand                          |
| Document      | An official paper (letter, form, contract)                   |
| Summarise     | Say the main points in fewer words                           |
| Context       | The words around a word that help you understand its meaning |

---

## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Simplify a Letter (Cert I)

Bring a letter or document from home (Centrelink, school, bank). Take a photo. Upload to ChatGPT. Write the simple version here:

Original topic: \_\_\_\_\_

Simple version: \_\_\_\_\_

## Activity 2: News Reading (Cert II)

Ask ChatGPT for a simple news story. Read it. Answer:

- What happened? \_\_\_\_\_
- Where did it happen? \_\_\_\_\_
- When did it happen? \_\_\_\_\_
- Write 3 new words you learned: \_\_\_\_\_,  
\_\_\_\_\_, \_\_\_\_\_

## Activity 3: Form Helper (Cert III)

Find an Australian government form online (e.g., Medicare enrolment form).

Upload it to ChatGPT. Write a summary of what the form asks for:

Form name: \_\_\_\_\_

Number of sections: \_\_\_\_\_

What information do you need to complete it? \_\_\_\_\_

# Chapter 8: AI for Job Searching and Resumes

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to write a resume in English
  - Use AI to prepare for job interviews
  - Find jobs using AI-powered search tools
- 

## Writing a Resume with AI

Many students say: *"I don't know how to write an Australian resume."*

AI can write one for you in 5 minutes.

### Step-by-step:

#### Open ChatGPT and type:

*"I need an Australian-style resume. Here is my information:*

*Name: [your name]*

*Phone: [your phone]*

*Email: [your email]*



*I worked as a [your job] in [your country] for [how many years].*

*I am studying English at AMEP in Melbourne.*

*I want to find work as a [cleaner / kitchen hand / warehouse worker / etc].*

*Please write a professional resume."*

ChatGPT will create a full resume. Then:

1. Copy it into a Word document or Google Doc
2. Read it carefully — make sure all the facts are correct
3. Ask your teacher to check it
4. Save it as a PDF

**Important:** AI may add skills you don't have. Always check and remove anything that is not true.

---

## Preparing for Job Interviews

### Practice with ChatGPT:

*"I have a job interview for a kitchen hand position at a restaurant. Please ask me common interview questions one at a time. After I answer, tell me how to improve my answer."*

### Common interview questions AI will practise with you:

1. "Tell me about yourself."
2. "Why do you want this job?"
3. "What experience do you have?"
4. "When can you start?"

5. "Can you work weekends?"

**The STAR method (for Cert III students):**

Ask ChatGPT: *"Teach me the STAR method for answering interview questions with an example."*

STAR = **S**ituation, **T**ask, **A**ction, **R**esult

---

**Finding Jobs with AI**

| Tool                 | What it does                                                            | Cost |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Seek.com.au</b>   | Australia's main job website — uses AI to match you with jobs           | Free |
| <b>Indeed.com.au</b> | Global job search — AI-powered recommendations                          | Free |
| <b>LinkedIn</b>      | Professional network — AI suggests jobs and connections                 | Free |
| <b>Google Jobs</b>   | Search "jobs near me" on Google — AI collects from all sites            | Free |
| <b>ChatGPT</b>       | Ask: "What entry-level jobs can I get in Melbourne with basic English?" | Free |

**AI Job Search Tip:**

Type into ChatGPT: *"I live in [your suburb]. I speak [your language] and basic English. I have no Australian work experience. What jobs should I apply for? Give me a list with the company type and how to apply."*

---

# Writing a Cover Letter with AI

A cover letter is a short letter you send with your resume.

**Type into ChatGPT:**

*"Write a cover letter for a cleaning job at [company name]. I am a new migrant, I am learning English at AMEP, I am reliable and hardworking. Keep it simple and professional."*

Then:

- 1. Read it — does it sound like you?
  - 2. Change anything that is not true
  - 3. Add your name and phone number
  - 4. Send it with your resume
- 

## Key Words

| Word         | Meaning                                              |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Resume (CV)  | A document listing your work experience and skills   |
| Cover letter | A short letter explaining why you want the job       |
| Interview    | A meeting where the employer asks you questions      |
| Entry-level  | A job that does not need experience                  |
| Reliable     | Someone you can depend on — they always come to work |
| Professional | Formal and suitable for work                         |

---

## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Build Your Resume (Cert I)

Use ChatGPT to create your resume. Print it. Bring it to class.

### Activity 2: Mock Interview (Cert II)

Use ChatGPT voice mode to practise three interview questions. Write down:

- The question ChatGPT asked: \_\_\_\_\_
- Your answer: \_\_\_\_\_
- How ChatGPT said you could improve: \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 3: Complete Job Application (Cert III)

1. Find a real job on seek.com.au that you could do
2. Use ChatGPT to help write your cover letter
3. Have your teacher review it
4. Apply for the job (if appropriate)

Job title: \_\_\_\_\_

Company: \_\_\_\_\_

Did you apply? YES / NO

---

## Teacher's Note

This is the most immediately useful chapter for students. Many AMEP students need work urgently. The resume exercise produces something they can use that same week. Consider running this as a workshop: students build resumes in class, teacher reviews, students leave with a PDF ready to send.

For Cert III students, the STAR method + mock interviews via ChatGPT voice mode is extremely effective preparation.

Estimated class time: 90 minutes

Materials needed: phones/laptops, printer access, [seek.com.au](https://seek.com.au)

# Chapter 9: AI for Government Services and Forms

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to understand and complete Australian government forms
  - Navigate Centrelink, Medicare, and myGov with AI help
  - Know which information is safe to share with AI and which is not
- 

## The Challenge

Australia has many government services. Each one has forms, websites, and phone numbers. For people learning English, this is one of the hardest parts of living in Australia.

AI can be your guide — but remember Chapter 3: **never type your personal numbers into AI.**

---

## Centrelink and Services Australia

### Understanding Letters from Centrelink

When you receive a letter:

- 1. Take a photo of it
- 2. Upload to ChatGPT
- 3. Ask: *"Please explain this Centrelink letter in simple English. What do I need to do?"*

**Do NOT type your CRN (Customer Reference Number) or TFN into ChatGPT.**

### Common Centrelink Tasks AI Can Help With

| Task                     | What to ask ChatGPT                                                                             |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Report income            | <i>"How do I report my income to Centrelink? Step by step."</i>                                 |
| Update address           | <i>"How do I change my address on myGov?"</i>                                                   |
| Understand a debt letter | Upload the letter (hide personal numbers first)                                                 |
| Find the right payment   | <i>"I am a new migrant in Australia with two children. What Centrelink payments can I get?"</i> |
| Prepare for a phone call | <i>"What questions will Centrelink ask me when I call about my payment?"</i>                    |

## Medicare

### Enrolling in Medicare

Ask ChatGPT: *"I just arrived in Australia on a permanent visa. How do I enrol in Medicare? What documents do I need?"*

## Understanding a Medicare Statement

Upload a photo of your Medicare statement (cover your Medicare number).

Ask: *"Please explain what each line on this Medicare statement means."*

## Bulk Billing

Ask: *"What is bulk billing? How do I find a bulk billing doctor near [your suburb]?"*

---

## myGov

myGov is the website that connects all government services (Centrelink, Medicare, ATO, Child Support).

### Common problems AI can help with:

- *"I forgot my myGov password. How do I reset it?"*
  - *"How do I link Medicare to my myGov account?"*
  - *"I got a message in my myGov inbox. What does it mean?"* (upload screenshot)
  - *"How do I update my bank details on myGov?"*
- 

## Tax (ATO)

At tax time (July-October), AI can help:

- *"I am lodging my first Australian tax return. What do I need?"*
- *"What is a TFN and how do I get one?"*
- *"I earned \$25,000 this year. How much tax will I pay approximately?"*



- *"What expenses can I claim on tax?"*

**Remember:** AI gives general guidance. For your specific tax situation, use a registered tax agent or the free ATO helpline.

---

## Safety Checklist for Government Forms

Before using AI with any government document:

- ☐ Cover or blur your TFN, CRN, Medicare number, and date of birth
  - ☐ Never type your password into AI
  - ☐ Use AI for understanding, not for submitting forms
  - ☐ Always verify important information on the official .gov.au website
  - ☐ If unsure, call the official phone number
- 

## Key Words

| Word       | Meaning                                       |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Centrelink | Australian government welfare service         |
| Medicare   | Australia's public health insurance           |
| myGov      | Government website that connects all services |
| ATO        | Australian Tax Office                         |
| TFN        | Tax File Number — your personal tax ID        |

|              |                                                          |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| CRN          | Customer Reference Number (Centrelink)                   |
| Bulk billing | When the doctor charges Medicare directly (free for you) |
| Lodge (tax)  | To submit your tax return                                |

---

## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Understand a Letter (Cert I)

Bring any government letter to class. Upload it to ChatGPT (cover personal numbers). Write the simple explanation:

Letter from: \_\_\_\_\_

What it says: \_\_\_\_\_

What I need to do: \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 2: Find a Service (Cert II)

Use ChatGPT to find out:

1. How to get a Medicare card: \_\_\_\_\_
2. The phone number for Centrelink: \_\_\_\_\_
3. What is the Translating and Interpreting Service (TIS)? \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 3: Tax Preparation (Cert III)

Use ChatGPT to learn about your first Australian tax return. Write:

- When is tax time in Australia? \_\_\_\_\_
- What documents do I need? \_\_\_\_\_
- What is the free way to lodge my tax return? \_\_\_\_\_

- Write one question you still have: \_\_\_\_\_

# Chapter 10: AI for Healthcare and Community

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## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will:

- Use AI to understand health information in English
  - Prepare for doctor appointments with AI
  - Find community services with AI help
- 

## At the Doctor

### Before Your Appointment

Ask ChatGPT:

*"I am going to the doctor. I have [describe your problem]. How do I explain this in English? Give me the exact words to say."*

#### Example:

*"I have a pain in my lower back. It started two weeks ago. It is worse in the morning. I took Panadol but it did not help. Give me the English sentences to tell my doctor."*

ChatGPT will give you ready-to-use sentences. You can read them from your phone at the appointment.

## Understanding Your Doctor

After the appointment, if you didn't understand something:

*"My doctor said I have 'gastroesophageal reflux.' What is this in simple English? What should I do?"*

Simple answer: *"This means stomach acid goes up into your throat. It causes heartburn. You should avoid spicy food, eat smaller meals, and take the medicine your doctor gave you."*

## Medicine Labels

Take a photo of your medicine bottle or box. Upload to ChatGPT:

*"Please explain this medicine label in simple English. How many should I take? When? Are there any warnings?"*

---

## Mental Health

Moving to a new country is stressful. It is normal to feel:

- Lonely
- Worried
- Homesick
- Overwhelmed

AI can help you find support:

*"I am a new migrant in [your city]. I feel very stressed and lonely. What free mental health services are available for me?"*

## Free services in Australia:

- **Beyond Blue:** 1300 22 4636 (24/7)
- **Lifeline:** 13 11 14 (24/7)
- **TIS (interpreter):** 131 450 (free interpreter for any phone call)

**You can call TIS first.** They will call the health service for you and translate in real time. This service is free.

---

## Finding Community Services

Ask ChatGPT:

*"I am a new migrant in [your suburb]. Help me find:*

- *Free English classes*
- *A community centre*
- *Food bank or emergency food*
- *Legal help*
- *A library with free Wi-Fi"*

AI will give you names, addresses, and phone numbers. Always verify by calling.

## Community Centres

Most suburbs have a Neighbourhood House or Community Centre that offers:

- Free English conversation groups
- Computer classes
- Playgroups for children

- Social events
  - Help with forms and letters
- 

## Emergency Situations

| Situation                            | Number              | Cost |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|------|
| Police, Fire, Ambulance              | <b>000</b>          | Free |
| Police (non-emergency)               | <b>131 444</b>      | Free |
| Translating and Interpreting Service | <b>131 450</b>      | Free |
| Poisons Information                  | <b>13 11 26</b>     | Free |
| Health advice (24/7 nurse)           | <b>1800 022 222</b> | Free |

**If you call 000:** Say your address first. Then say what happened. If you need an interpreter, say: *"I need an interpreter. My language is [your language]."*

---

## Using AI for Health — Safety Rules

1. **AI is not a doctor.** It can help you understand, but it cannot diagnose or treat you.
  2. **For emergencies, call 000.** Do not ask ChatGPT.
  3. **Always follow your doctor's advice** over what AI says.
  4. **Do not type your Medicare number** or personal health details into AI.
  5. AI is best for: understanding, preparing, translating, and finding services.
-

# Key Words

| Word          | Meaning                                              |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Symptom       | A sign that something is wrong (pain, fever, cough)  |
| Appointment   | A scheduled meeting (with a doctor, teacher, etc.)   |
| Prescription  | A note from a doctor for medicine                    |
| Mental health | Your emotional and psychological wellbeing           |
| Interpreter   | A person who translates spoken language in real time |
| Emergency     | A dangerous situation that needs immediate help      |

## Practice Activities

### Activity 1: Doctor Visit Preparation (Cert I)

Think of a health problem you have (or make one up). Ask ChatGPT to help you explain it in English. Write the sentences:

Problem: \_\_\_\_\_

English sentences: \_\_\_\_\_

### Activity 2: Find Community Services (Cert II)

Use ChatGPT to find three services in your suburb:

1. Service: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

2. Service: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

3. Service: \_\_\_\_\_ Phone: \_\_\_\_\_



### Activity 3: Health Literacy Quiz (Cert III)

Use ChatGPT to explain these common Australian health terms:

1. Bulk billing: \_\_\_\_\_
  2. PBS (Pharmaceutical Benefits Scheme): \_\_\_\_\_
  3. GP referral: \_\_\_\_\_
  4. Mental health care plan: \_\_\_\_\_
  5. TIS National: \_\_\_\_\_
- 

### A Final Note

You started this book wondering what AI is. Now you can:

- Use AI to learn English
- Write resumes and emails
- Understand government letters
- Prepare for doctor visits
- Stay safe online
- Find jobs, services, and community support

AI is your tool. English is your bridge. Australia is your home.

**Keep learning. Keep practising. You are doing something incredibly brave.**

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*Thank you for reading AI Literacy for ESL Students.*

*Written by Mircea Matthews — AMEP Teacher, Melbourne, Australia.*